

# The Queen's Gambit challenges support

Opening Decisions

## THE IDEA

After 1.d4 d5 2.c4, White attacks the d5 pawn's support structure and offers a flank pawn. The goal is central influence and activity, not a promise to sacrifice a pawn permanently in every variation.

## WORKED EXAMPLE

If Black captures with 2...dxc4, the d-pawn leaves the center. White can develop and often recover c4 later. Trying to keep that pawn at any cost can leave Black behind in development or create queenside targets.

## TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

**What should White evaluate before rushing to recover c4?**

## ANSWER AND REASONING

Development, king safety, and whether Black can safely hold the extra pawn. A useful developing move may be more valuable than an immediate queen move just to restore material equality.

## TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

**Central compensation can justify a temporary pawn investment.**